

Budget Planner

Thank you for your purchase. Here is everything you need to get started.

Your files

File	What for
Budget-Planner.xlsx	The spreadsheet with all formulas. Opens in Excel or Google Sheets. Only fill in the yellow cells.
This guide	Setup in 10 minutes and tips.

Google Sheets: drive.google.com → New → File upload → choose the file → right-click → Open with → Google Sheets. All functions used are available in Google Sheets.

Set up in 10 minutes

1. **Income:** your take-home pay per month. A yearly bonus goes on its own line with frequency „annual“.
2. **Expenses:** take your last three bank statements and last year's bills. Enter every item the way you pay it: rent monthly, insurance annually. The „per month“ column converts everything.
3. **Type:** Need (can't change short term), Want (can change), Save (retirement, savings, extra debt payments).
4. **Summary:** left over or short, your monthly transfer to sinking funds, Need/Want/Save, emergency fund.
5. **Yearly Tracker:** at month end, enter what you really spent. More than 10 % over plan turns red.

Sinking funds: the step that changes everything

Most budgets break on bills that don't come every month: insurance, car costs, taxes not withheld, holidays. The planner adds them up per month. Set up an automatic transfer for exactly that amount to a separate account right after payday, and pay those bills from there.

Need, Want, Save

The 50/30/20 rule (half for needs, 30 % for wants, 20 % for saving) is a guide, not a law. Where rent and insurance are high, needs are often 60 % or more; then wants have to shrink, not saving. Warning sign: housing above a third of your income.

Emergency fund

Aim for three months of your needs in a savings account, not invested. Build it before investing or paying extra on low-interest debt.

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